

CRYSIS 2

Just another cheat-happy wimp
readersletters@thinkdigit.com

First up, this is neither a walk-through nor a gist of the storyline of *Crysis 2*. After the hype of the first part, if you still don't know what *Crysis* is about, crawl back under that mouldy rock you emerged from. It's completely pointless to go into the storyline of this game because if you have a capable PC, and like FPS games, you will get your hands on this title. Actually, even if you don't have a capable PC, you'll still probably play it anyway.

It's always been pointless, in my humble opinion, however, to play *Crysis* on anything but the fastest hardware your money can afford. It's always been a visual franchise, with eye-candy galore. It's also the first game that

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made me feel like I'm playing with semi-God-mode turned on – with the new Nanosuit 2.0's Power mode, both strength and speed are enabled together to allow you to manhandle aliens and humans alike; go into Stealth mode to stalk enemies and even evade them; and of course Armor, which means you're about as vulnerable as a president's bulletproof motorcade – for about 20 seconds only unless you cheat.

It's not like this game's easy though. I first played it in Recruit mode since my gaming skills aren't what they used to be. Soldier or Veteran mode is the one fans will choose to play – unlike wimpy little me who had a deadline to write this article and just wanted to finish playing the game.

Recruit difficulty is like playing the game with you dressed in Armor, and with the enemies half-lobotomised.

There's hardly any AI to speak of in the beginning but they get a wee bit tougher as the campaign progresses. Like butterflies turning into

What's good

- Great graphics, as expected, but pretty decent AI in Soldier mode
- Very nice background score that sticks in your head.
- Seems to perform better than *Crysis*
- Suit control is easier

What sucks

- No more punching
- Very linear, and maps aren't as huge as I'd like
- Campaign is too short

Suggested System Requirements for 1920x1200

CPU: Intel i5 / Athlon X6 (3 GHz)
 GPU: GTX 260 / HD 6850
 RAM: 4 GB
 Windows 7 with DX11
 12 GB free HDD space

rabbits – what? Rabbits have bloodshot eyes, they're scary I tell you!

Graphically speaking, there's a 3D mode available, but I liked what I had for lunch today, and felt like keeping it down for a change. We've seen a little too much of New York being destroyed, whether in a game, movie or on CNN, but this still has some interesting shots. Why do they always destroy the Statue of Liberty though? It's like *Aliens* land and say, "Hmm that looks important, let's squish it!", even though there's no people or armaments anywhere near it.

Anyway, as you've no doubt noticed, so far I've just given you a bunch of useless information and some personal remarks, but not really told you how good or bad this game really is. That's because I played the game without reading any of the reviews or comments about it first, and that just meant that I had to figure out things for myself, and with a game this short, you need all the help you can get to extend the play time. In fact, I'd say don't even bother reading any more reviews, just go play it and make up your own damn mind.. 

See! Evil-looking and about as scary as the enemies in Recruit mode

